

Stone by Stone

Asleep beneath a midnight sun
A stolen blessing in my hands
I held the light till night was done
But now I can barely stand
The morning found me changed and limping
So I marked the place with a single stone
I tried to capture what had met me
Still afraid but not alone

Stone by stone, we mark the places
Stone by stone, we call them sacred
Stone by stone, the mystery has a home
Something solid for the wonder
Something we can call our own

We gathered up our many moments
Built our altars, staked our claims
We raised a shelter for the sacred
But kept the wonder where it came
We needed rules and holy places
Something solid, someone crowned
But we chose less than what You offered
And even there You still were found

Stone by stone, we marked the places
Stone by stone, You called them sacred
Stone by stone, You met us on the way
But the house we built to hold You
Would become a tomb one day

But then the stones became too heavy
When mercy met us in the dust
We held the law like final judgment
And found the law had turned on us
The Cornerstone now lived among us
But not the shape that we had planned
So we the builders then rejected
And crucified the Son of Man

Stone by stone, we marked the places
Stone by stone, we called them sacred
Stone by stone, lay scattered in the sand
What we carried there as judgment
Proved too heavy for our hands

We thought we knew You by the traces
Of sacred stones that marked the way
We thought the signs could hold the mystery
Till what had led us hid Your face
Then mercy reached beyond our knowing
And love refused the shape we made
Past every wall we built to hold You
And then the stone was rolled away

Stone by stone, You moved the mountains
Stone by stone, You broke what bound us
Stone by stone, You came to show the way
That the grave is not the ending
The living stone still lives today

And even though I keep on wrestling
There's a solid place to land
The Living Stone is still a mystery
But on this solid rock I stand